



Internet freedom at risk

Google reports show increased number of requests from governments to remove content from the web. <http://digit.in/MqX5aW>

ICS update for Xperia Active

Sony has started rolling out Android 4.0 ICS update for Sony Xperia Active. When the update arrives on your phone, you will get a notification

environment. Overclocking was quite simple on this board as the UEFI BIOS is quite easy to navigate and has a separate section for adjusting the OC settings.

The ASRock Z77 Extreme4 was one board that looked very impressive. Borrowing from the design aesthetics seen in the Z68 Extreme series of boards, the Extreme4 sports the angular heatsink above the VRM. It comes with the XFast 555 technology feature which provides fast optimized RAM speeds, fast LAN speeds and quicker USB 3.0 speeds. It offers the Dehumidifier function, which was also seen on the Gigabyte boards, which prevents humidity in the air from causing damage to your system. Another feature offered with this board is the Online Management Guard, which allows you to set internet

UD3H scored higher due to the form factor. It emerged as the winner in features and specifications, board layout and package bundle whereas the ASUS board won with the Overclocking options. Keeping the pricing in mind, the Gigabyte Z77X-UD3H won the Best Buy in this category.

BETWEEN ₹13,001 TO ₹17,000

With the Intel DZ77GA-70K reference Z77 board, we were expecting a non-UEFI BIOS, but not only did it prove us wrong on that front, it also left us thoroughly impressed. There is a homepage which has three main tabs namely Processor, Graphics and Memory which allow you to tweak options within them. Instead of the top to down approach, Intel has gone with the tabbed approach in all the options under the Advanced Menu options. Overclocking from the BIOS is child's play. The DZ77GA-70K also comes with a load of accessories such as a mouse pad, a WiFi module which goes in one of the PCI x1 slot, a WiFi antenna,

plier, voltages among others. If you place a large CPU cooler, the graphics card on the first PCIe slot and the memory module on the first DIMM slot get affected. Just like ASUS it also comes with a BIOS flash option, allowing you to update the BIOS with just a USB drive.

MSI had three boards namely Z77A-G45, Z77A-G43 and Z77A-GD65. All three boards have minor differences with the G45 and GD55 being almost similar in the feature set offered. The G43 offers two extra USB 2.0 ports and three PCI slots (which are absent on the other two boards). The G43 has lesser PCIe x16 slots as compared to the other two boards. Visually the only thing that you can tell apart among the three boards is the VRM heatsink quality, which is the best with the GD55. All three boards feature the UEFI BIOS which is very easy to navigate and has a dedicated section for overclocking. This same UEFI BIOS can be replicated in the OS with ClickBIOS II. The arrangement of SATA

ports on the G43 is not ideal as all the SATA ports point upwards. Wire management can get tricky if you have a long graphics card in the second PCIe slot. GD55 and G45 come with voltage check points whereas only



ASUS Maximus V Gene

the GD55 has the onboard OC Genie II button.

ASUS had the mainstream P8Z77-V and the gamers board Maximus V Gene. The Maximus V Gene is one the best looking boards in this test with a neat red and black colour theme. It comes with all the bells and whistles associated with a board belonging to the Republic Of Gamers' series including ROG connect, Supreme FXIII, Extreme Engine Digi+II among others. The layout is quite dense with extremely sturdy heat-sinks on both the VRM and the southbridge, which even lights up once you power the system. The Supreme FXIII chip and its surrounding circuitry is separated from the rest of the board with the help of line which illuminates on powering the system. It helps to keep the dedicated sound segment free from noise produced by the rest of the



Gigabyte Z77X-UD3H

access restrictions. The UEFI BIOS on the ASRock boards is not as attractive as the ones seen on ASUS or MSI boards, but its quite functional and allows for easy overclocking. We managed to overclock the processor to around 4.4GHz on air thereby increasing the Cinebench R11.5 score by over 20 per cent.

Winner

It was a close fight between Gigabyte Z77X-UD3H and ASUS P8Z77M PRO, but the

an external USB 3.0 bracket. The TZ77XE4 is the flagship board from Biostar, but when compared with competition's flagship boards it's found to be lacking in certain aspects. It has a very decent feature set mind you, but the BIOS implementation could have been much better. BIOS overclocking options are not that exhaustive. It comes with a dedicated overclocking utility called Toverclocker which is quite handy allowing you to tweak multi-



Gigabyte Z77X-UD5H WiFi